

tates making screenshot pages (i.e., a number of thumbnails are shown together as in an album).

7.10 Web Servers

A Web server is responsible for accepting HTTP requests from clients (Web browsers), and serving the requests through HTTP responses and data contents (Web pages—documents and linked objects).

7.10.1 Apache Web Server (www.apache.org)

The Apache HTTP Server Project is one of the most popular servers. The effort is to have an open-source HTTP server for most operating systems including UNIX and Windows NT. And, the result is a secure, and efficient server that provides HTTP services in sync with current HTTP standards. As a matter of fact surveys have indicated that close to 70 per cent of Web sites use Apache.

How To Run It

Apache is run as a service on Windows NT/2000/XP, or as a console application on Windows 9x/ME. On Unix, the `httpd` program is run as a daemon that executes continuously in the background.

Operating System Requirements

TCP/IP networking must be installed on the system. On Windows NT 4.0, installing Service Pack 6 is strongly recommended.

Downloading Apache for Windows

The latest versions of Apache are found at <http://httpd.apache.org/download.cgi>.

For Windows installations, the user should download the version with the `.msi` extension. This is a single Microsoft Installer file, which contains a ready-to-run version of Apache.